LAIEN ZOU

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EDUCATION

University of Toronto **Toronto, ON**
Bachelor of Science in **Computer Science** Sep. 2025 – Present
Specialist in Data Science & Computer Science

- **CGPA: 4.0/4.0**
- **Coursework:** Data Structures and Analysis, Computer Organization, Probability and Statistics, Software Design

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Programming Languages:** Python, Java, R, Latex
- **Developing Tools:** Pycharm, Intellij, VS Code, Jupyterhub, Rstudio, Git
- **Frameworks & Libraries:** NumPy, Pandas
- **Languages:** English (Fluent), Mandarin (Native)

PROJECT

Steam Games Recommender | Python, Graph Algorithms Mar. 2026 – Apr. 2026
CSC111 Course Project *Github*

- Developed a graph-based recommendation system that recommends Steam games based on genre, tags, platforms, and user review data.
- Implemented game similarity using **Jaccard similarity** and applied review-quality filters based on positive review ratios and review counts.
- Processed and filtered a dataset of **4,000+** games to improve recommendation relevance and reduce computational overhead.

African countries' electricity Investigation | R, Statistical Analysis Feb. 2026 – Mar. 2026
STA130 Course Project

- Analyzed data from **54 African countries** to investigate relationships between electrification, poverty, population density, HDI, electricity cost, and per-capita consumption.
- Applied linear regression and exploratory data analysis to identify factors associated with electricity access.
- Found a negative association between electrification and poverty rates, with low-density countries showing lower electricity access, informing potential indicators for the Clean Air Task Force (CATF) electricity sector scorecard.

Text-Based Adventure Game | Python Feb. 2026
CSC111 Course Project *Github*

- Built an interactive console-based adventure game with a 5×5 grid, inventory system, item collection and traps
- Implemented a Tic-Tac-Toe mini-game using object-oriented design and a custom **Puzzle** class, allowing players to compete against a simplified AI.
- Designed game logic for player movement, collecting items, score recording and win/loss conditions through an interactive Python console interface.

QUALIFICATIONS

- **Dean's List** : | University of Toronto Jun 2026
  Faculty of Arts & Science students with a cumulative GPA of 3.50 or higher after completing 5 credits
- **AP Scholar with Distinction** : | College Board Aug 2025
  Achieving an average score of at least 3.5 on all AP Exams taken, and scores of 3 or higher on five or more exams.